Painted, Not Waiting

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 7

The cover was dry. The earlier note still said it was waiting. Nib proposed repainting it to make the scene match the old note. Lark showed the completed-work record instead. A record should follow the actual work, rather than make finished work happen again.

“It has been waiting for its note to catch up,” Nib observed. “We can help the note,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cats**

“We already met the different ed sounds,” Lark reminded you warmly. “When hope already ends in e, add d for hoped. Bake becomes baked the same way. Painted keeps its extra ending syllable. Read the visible base and the actual change before rejoining each word.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try hoped, baked, painted. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the completed-work note,” Lark invited gently. “Does the dry cover need new paint, or does its old label need updating?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam baked. Pat painted the box.**

“Who painted the box?” Lark asked gently. “What completed action belongs to Sam?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib checked the real surface with the keeper. Lark updated the note to painted and dry, leaving its earlier date visible. The cover fitted over the station without a new coat of paint. Underneath, the moving feed belt had a loose side guide that needed checking next.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write painted beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the finished cover on the machine. A more accurate note had saved a needless job. The feed belt could be tested once its loose edge was properly guided.